626 Exchange Seats

PLATFORM	DIFFICULTY	DATE
Platform: LeetCode	MEDIUM	Solved: June 29, 2026

Input

- 1 table — Seat with columns id, student
- id is the primary key, starts from 1 and increments continuously

Output

- Swap student names between every two consecutive seats
- If total seats is **odd**, last seat remains unchanged
- Result ordered by id ascending

Key Insights

- This is a **computed column** problem — we change the id value, not the student, to achieve the swap effect (clever trick!)
- Odd ids move forward (id+1), even ids move backward (id-1)
- Special edge case: last seat when count is odd → must check against MAX(id)

Observations

- Swapping id values (instead of student values) and then ORDER BY id automatically rearranges students correctly
- The last odd seat (when total is odd) has no pair → must remain unchanged
- id % 2 = 1 → odd; id % 2 = 0 → even

Approach

3 conditions checked in priority order:

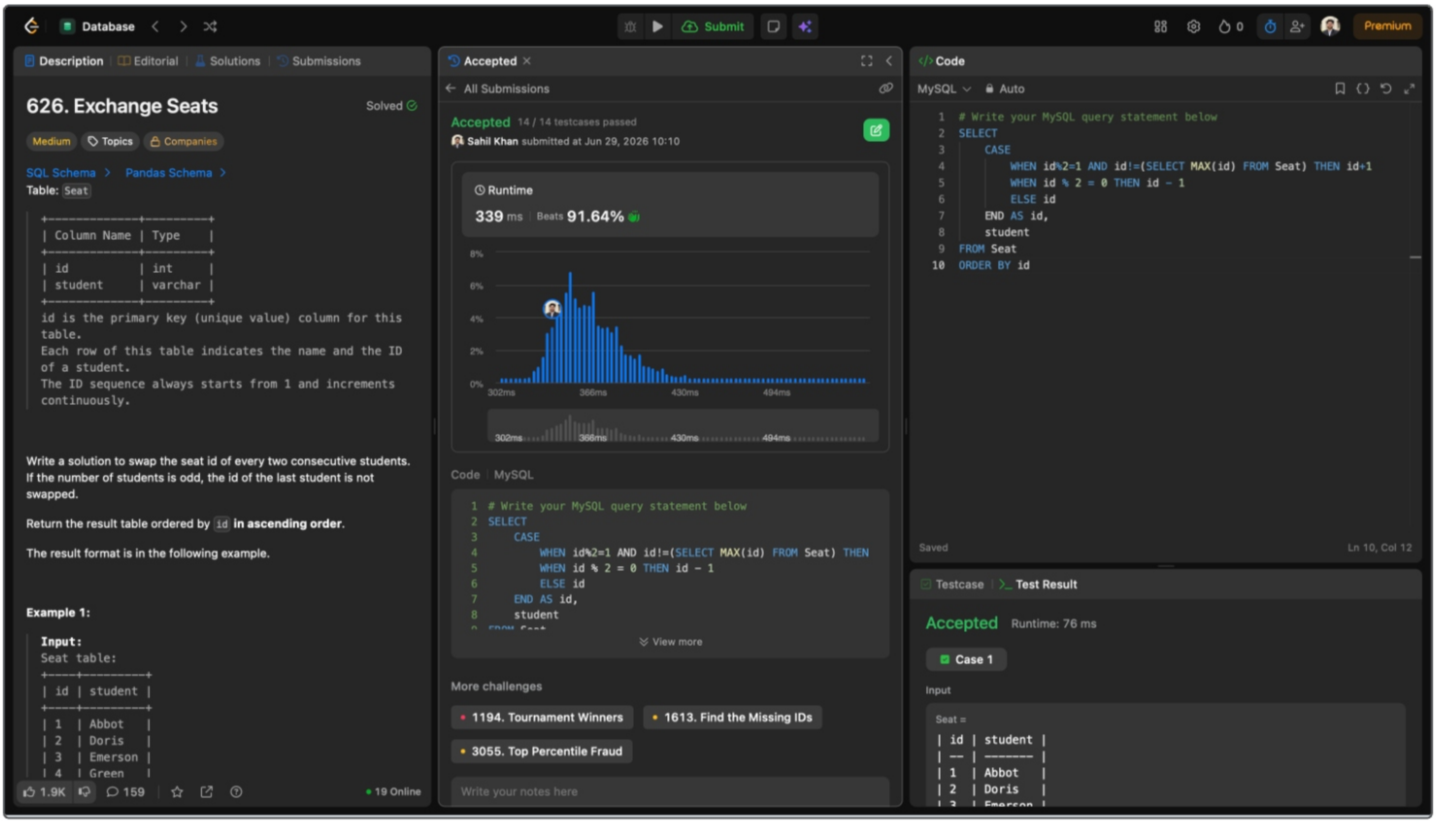
- Odd id AND not the last seat → new id = id + 1
- Even id → new id = id - 1
- Otherwise (last odd seat) → new id = id (unchanged)

Algorithm

For each row in Seat:
 IF id is odd AND id != MAX(id)
  → new_id = id + 1
 ELSE IF id is even
  → new_id = id - 1
 ELSE (last odd seat)
  → new_id = id (unchanged)
ORDER BY new_id ascending

Time & Space Complexity

	Complexity
TC	O(N log N) — sorting after computing new ids
SC	O(N) — storing computed ids for each row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626. Exchange Seats
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SQL Schema
Pandas Schema
Table: Seat
+-------------+---------+
| Column Name | Type |
+-------------+---------+
| id | int |
| student | varchar |
+-------------+---------+
id is the primary key (unique value) column for this table.
Each row of this table indicates the name and the ID of a student.
The ID sequence always starts from 1 and increments continuously.
Write a solution to swap the seat id of every two consecutive students. If the number of students is odd, the id of the last student is not swapped.
Return the result table ordered by id in ascending order.
The result format is in the following example.
Example 1:
Input:
Seat table:
+----+---------+
| id | student |
+----+---------+
1	Abbot
2	Doris
3	Emerson
4	Green
1.9K
159
19 Online
Accepted
All Submissions
Accepted 14 / 14 testcases passed
Sahil Khan submitted at Jun 29, 2026 10:10
Runtime
339 ms | Beats 91.64%
8%
6%
4%
2%
0%
302ms
366ms
430ms
494ms
Code | MySQL
Write your MySQL query statement below
SELECT
CASE
WHEN id%2=1 AND id!=(SELECT MAX(id) FROM Seat) THEN
WHEN id % 2 = 0 THEN id - 1
ELSE id
END AS id,
student
View more
More challenges
1194. Tournament Winners
1613. Find the Missing IDs
3055. Top Percentile Fraud
Write your notes here
Code
MySQL
Auto
Write your MySQL query statement below
SELECT
CASE
WHEN id%2=1 AND id!=(SELECT MAX(id) FROM Seat) THEN id+1
WHEN id % 2 = 0 THEN id - 1
ELSE id
END AS id,
student
FROM Seat
ORDER BY id
Saved
Ln 10, Col 12
Testcase | Test Result
Accepted
Runtime: 76 ms
Case 1
Input
Seat =
id	student
1	Abbot
2	Doris